



Below are a few tips and tricks to boost your laptop's performance while also improving productivity and – to a certain extent – battery life.

Install an SSD

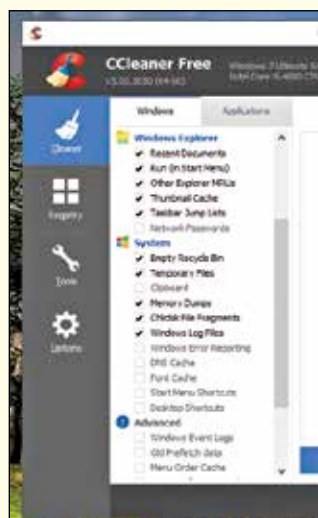
Upgrading to an SSD from a run-of-the-mill HDD is arguably the most noticeable upgrade you can make for a smoother UX and improved overall computing experience. Even an entry-level SSD, when compared with a high-performance 10,000 rpm HDD, has a markedly faster response time (up to over 30 times faster) as well as faster sequential and random read-write operation times. Loading your operating system, applications and games from an SSD can result in up to 200% faster startup and loading times. This faster operating time leads to more disk idling, which results in a slight improvement in battery life. It doesn't hurt that SSDs have no moving parts either, resulting in protection from bumps and even more battery life.

In the past, these devices might have been looked upon as a slightly hubristic upgrade, especially considering the ridiculous price per gigabyte. However, these days you can grab an affordable 240 GB SSD for as low as ₹8,000. Those looking for a more affordable deal can opt for a 120 GB drive (~₹4,500), which should be sufficient to store your OS and important applications, as well as a few

games. Any media that you want to store would of course be better off on your portable HDD.

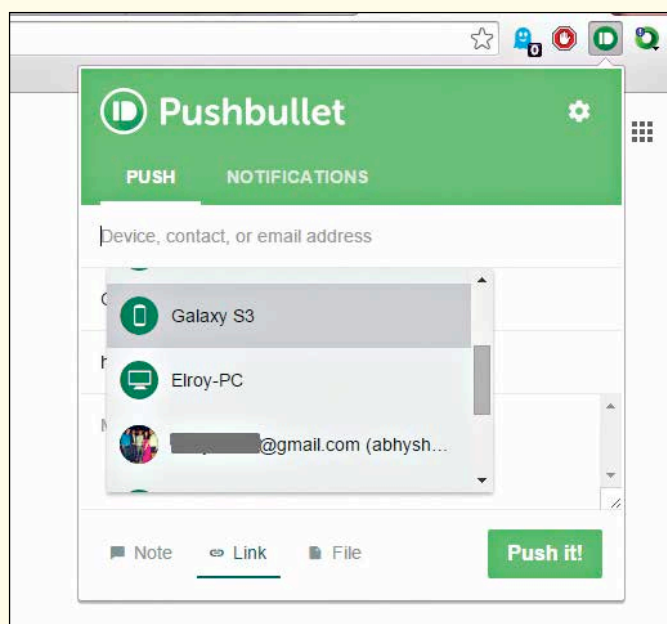
Upgrade RAM

Today, with applications getting more memory intensive (we're looking at you, Firefox), adding additional RAM has almost become an inevitable upgrade. Most laptops now come with minimum 4 GB RAM, expandable up to 8 GB. While 4 GB would have been sufficient for regular usage, those using graphic designing and image editing applications like Maya, Coreldraw and Photoshop will see a definite improvement in performance after upgrading to 8 GB.



Customize your cleaning needs

Laptop RAM is now extremely affordable, with a 4 GB kit setting you back by just ₹2,500. Ensure that you check the total number of RAM slots (standard laptops come with two slots) as well as the number of free slots: for example, if your laptop comes with 4 GB of RAM and it mentions "expandable up to 8 GB," then your laptop is most probably loaded with a single stick of 4 GB RAM. You can verify this with a tool like CPUZ that will give you a detailed explanation of the type of RAM on your system, including the number of free slots.



Push links and images to your devices or those of a friend

Use a Laptop Cooler

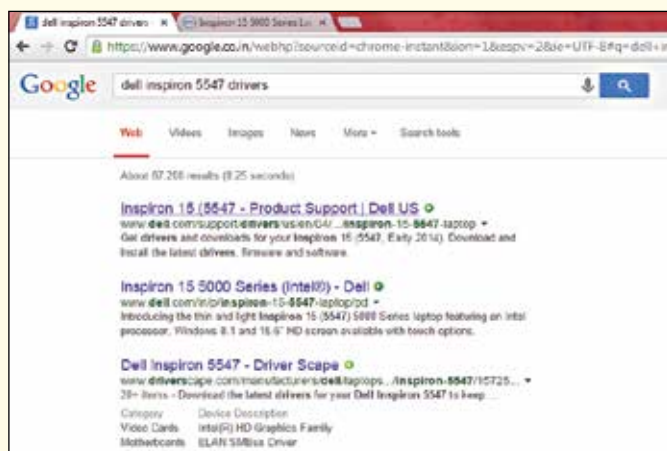
While laptops these days come with much improved cooling systems, countless laptops in the past have been lost to overheating owing to dust accumulation and unsolicited overclocking. An ideal solution for this is the use of an external laptop cooler (a.k.a. "cooling pad") which also doubles up as a convenient resting surface for your laptop during use in bed.

There are two types available: an active cooling type, which is powered via USB and either draws hot air away from the laptop or pumps cool air towards it, and a passive cooling

type that uses a type of organic salt compound to absorb excess heat. Cooling pads come in a variety of sizes to correspond with that of your laptop and start at an affordable rate of ₹800 and go up to ₹5,000 for premium brands.

Install CCleaner

A major culprit of decreased system performance is the accumulation of temporary Internet files and redundant application data. CCleaner is an easy-to-use application that aims to clean such virtual gunk that gradually builds up in your storage. You can customize its settings



Google your laptop name for a link to its support page